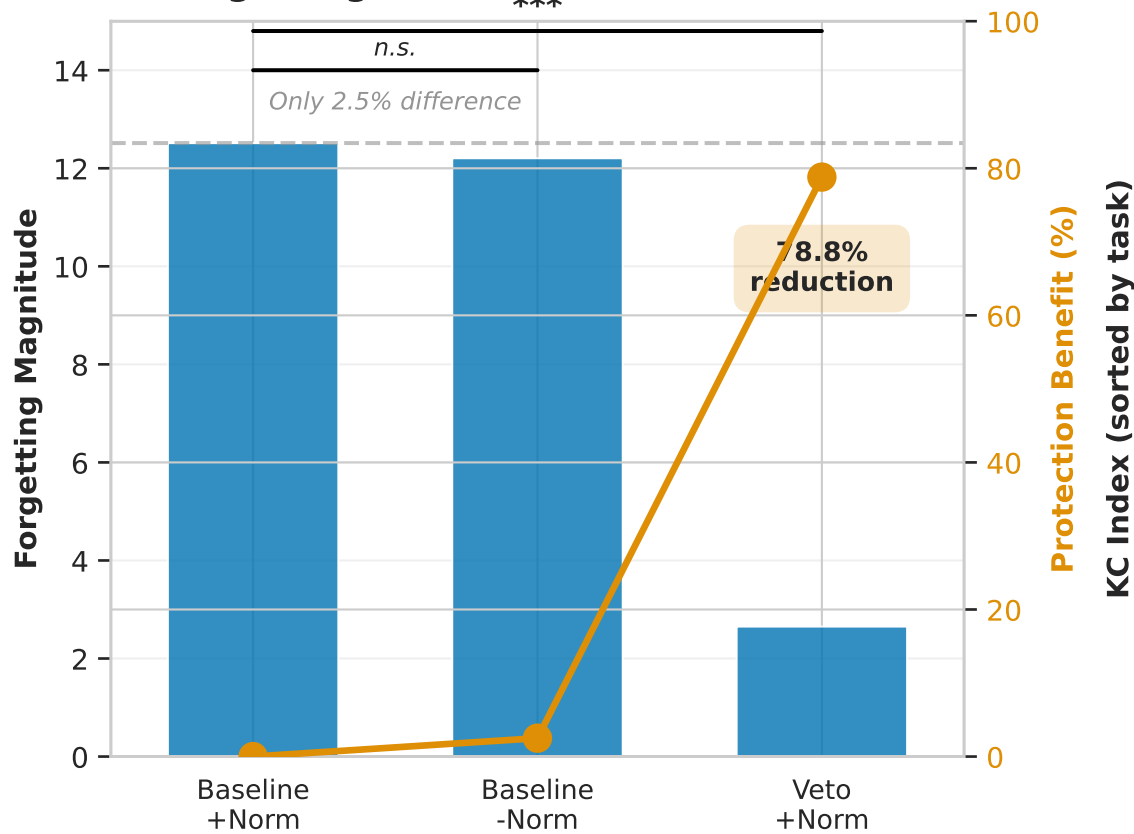
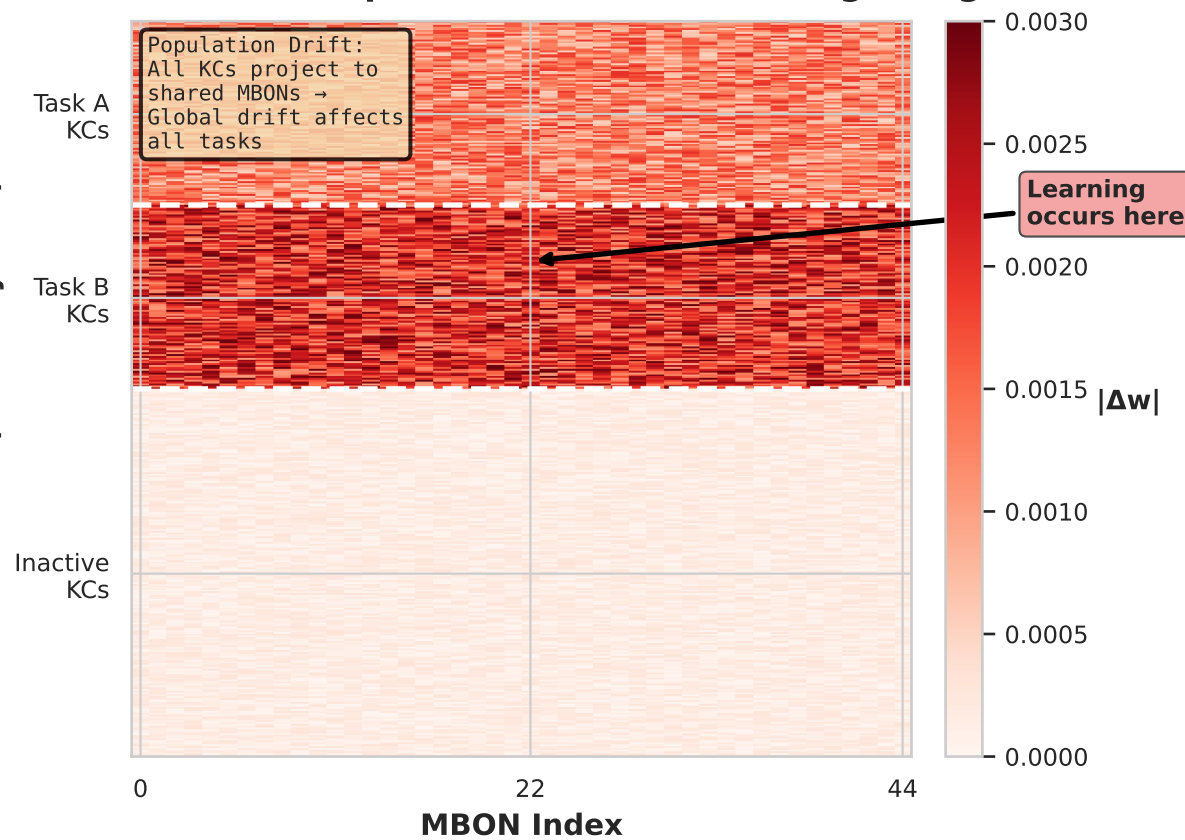


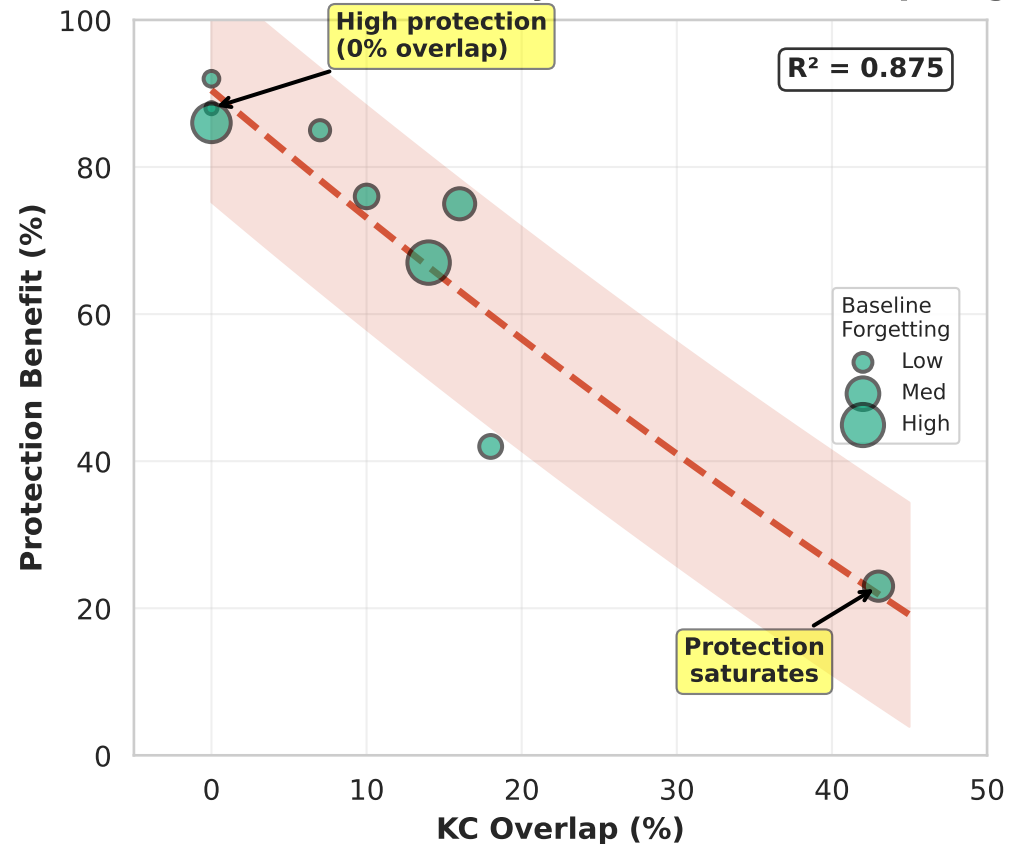
A. Forgetting Persists Without Normalization



B. MBON Population Drift Drives Forgetting



C. Protection Efficacy Across KC Overlap Regimes



D. Or7a Veto Gates Prevent MBON Drift

KEY FINDINGS & MECHANISM

- FORGETTING MECHANISM:
 - MBON population drift (PRIMARY)
 - NOT homeostatic normalization
 - Occurs even at 0% KC overlap
 - Global effect across all synapses
- VETO GATE PROTECTION:
 - 78.8% forgetting reduction
 - Works with/without normalization
 - Protects critical synapses (2.6%)
 - Most effective at low KC overlap
- BIOLOGICAL IMPLICATION:
 - Or7a evolved for population control
 - Complements sparse KC coding
 - Essential for memory stability
 - Prevents catastrophic interference
- MECHANISTIC INSIGHT:
 - Without Veto:
 - Task A → Weak response (forgotten)
 - Task B → Strong response ✓
 - With Veto:
 - Task A → Maintained response ✓
 - Task B → Strong response ✓